
GCC term sheets look different this quarter. Debt is showing up before equity.

Founders are quietly choosing private debt over equity, tired of defending a valuation nobody in the room believes.

**Debt first means no mark to defend,
ownership stays intact through the
trough, and the cap table stays clean.**

The lender underwrites cash flow, not a narrative.

The capital that lends first gets the best seat at the next equity round: information rights, relationship, first call.

This isn't a retreat from venture. It's a quiet rebalancing of instruments, and the corridor read is worth following.

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